



McDonald's is worth more...

...than the ENTIRE market of cryptocurrencies! This occurred after the 80% plus fall of the industry. <https://dgit.in/dec18-119-1>



Google gets politically aware

Google will now demand verification from European political parties buying ads ahead of the EU elections. <https://dgit.in/dec18-119-2>

ties for sending a probe to study the object. The interstellar asteroid looked like it was on a collision course – straight to Venus. Project Spaceguard had been configured to alert the detection of any potential strikes on Earth, but was not responsible for detecting potential collision events of other bodies in the Solar System. Fen took her findings to her supervisor, Dr Vipin Mehta.

The wheels in Mehta's head started turning. He smiled. "Fen, this is going to be quite a spectacle".

02 DECEMBER, 2200

Husbishag Tesserae, Venus

11/2206 U4 ploughed through the thick Venusian atmosphere as though it was not even there. Within a few seconds, it had reached the ground. The shockwaves rippled around the planet. 11/2206 U4 was about a hundred kilometers wide, but its impact was equal to a 400 kilometer wide asteroid from the solar system striking Venus. This was because of the velocity of the strike. It was enough to shift the mantle dynamics of the planet, changing its very tectonics. Volcanic activity sprouted in the area. Over a period of time Venus would become hotter, and even more hellish.

18 JUNE, 2201

Pasadena, USA

For the past few years, the number of interstellar objects had been steadily increasing, and now there were upwards of 20 every year. Fen was wondering if this was because of improved detection methods, or something else was at work. Her console went crazy with a series of alerts. Fen had never heard that particular sound before, because it meant one thing – the identification of a potentially hazardous object on a trajectory that would end in the Earth. Multiple pings at once was really strange. She looked at her console, and her eyes went wide. It was not one, or two objects, but a swarm of 40. All of them appeared to be originating from TYC 4742-1027-1. The star was known to have an exoplanet with an extremely large orbit. While she printed out the report, Fen was sure that Dr Mehta would not be smiling this time.

It took a few days for the news to spread, but the epapers had a field day with the headlines. They all screamed about an incoming armageddon strike – asteroids aimed at the Earth by an alien civilisation.

23 AUGUST, 2210

Erice, Sicily

Dr Vipin Mehta takes the stage at the specially convened international panel. "Over the course of two and a half centuries of space exploration, we have launched over 75,000 satellites into space. Most of these satellites in low Earth orbit are now junk. In fact, 5 percent of the orbital debris in low Earth orbit are failed technological demonstrations of deorbiting satellites, designed specifically to clean up the space junk. Now, a multinational team from Europe has an ambitious proposal of using all this space junk, as a response to the incoming

interstellar armageddon. The idea is to use the most effective method known so far, sweeping up the debris using the Japanese electrodynamic nets. The satellites will be raised to an altitude of 8,000 kilometers, which would put them right in the middle of the two Van Allen Belts. Here, a Kessler cascade will be induced, where the debris will be broken up into small bits and pieces, by making them repeatedly collide against each other. Then, four originator satellites will be deployed with the experiments and equipment on board necessary to capture and store the antimatter. The modular design allows for integration of other high energy particle physics experiments in the future, as and when the need arises. Each of the satellites will be equipped with electromagnets and a 3D printer. The electromagnets are to capture the material from the debris, and the 3D printer will repurpose them for creating the particle accelerator tunnel. Just like the many Hyperloop constructions on Earth, the accelerator "train" will build its own tracks using the captured satellite debris. Together, these four trains will complete the particle accelerator around the Earth, forming the Globatron that Enrico Fermi envisioned during the early days of high energy particle physics. The Fermatron can accelerate particles to energy levels of 5 PeV, which is 200 times higher than the Eloisatron, currently the most powerful particle accelerator on the planet. This new accelerator is what we need to produce the antimatter rockets and antimatter bombs to take out the alien asteroids."

17 OCTOBER, 2222

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Nariman Madiyarev is reading a pre-publication paper on arXiv. A team from Berlin has redone the calculations of the incoming asteroids. None of them are on a trajectory to impact the Earth. They will all pass safely through the solar system. They are moving so fast, that the antimatter rockets cannot really deflect them anyway.

Additionally, the research shows that the velocity of the swarm is too high to have originated from TYC 4742-1027-1. Instead, the asteroids have been pinballing between multiple systems for billions of years, which makes it unlikely that an alien civilisation is deliberately targeting the Earth. The paper goes on to note that the swarm is most probably made up of fragments of a tidally disrupted planet, that got broken up by its host star. The origin system is most likely Eta Carinae. If there was any alien civilisation in the origin system, then the planet it was on most probably got torn up in a cataclysmic event. Instead of causing an armageddon, the swarm is a result of one.

After reading the paper, Madiyarev makes a call to Dr Mehta. He gets little more than a laugh and vague jokes about how nobody is going to care about the paper, and people will believe in an incoming apocalypse whether or not there is science to back it up.

Madiyarev cannot sleep that night. He keeps thinking of various ways in which the antimatter bombs hanging above the Earth can be used. 